

Information Security and Acceptable Use Policy

Document owner: Information Security Version 7.2, effective 2026-05-01 Applies to: all TechLance Solutions employees, contractors, and contingent workers

Security awareness training is required within the first 10 business days of employment and annually thereafter. System access is not granted until it is complete.

Accounts and authentication

Multi-factor authentication is mandatory on every TechLance account. It must be configured before any system access is granted, including on day one of employment.

Passwords must be at least 16 characters. TechLance provides a password manager and its use is required for all work credentials.

Never share credentials. This includes with a manager, with IT Support, and with anyone claiming to be either. TechLance staff will never ask for a password.

Accounts are provisioned by role. Access beyond the role default requires a request approved by the data owner, not by the requester's manager alone.

Data classification

Class	Definition	Examples
Public	Approved for external release	Published marketing material, job postings
Internal	Default for company information	Org charts, internal process docs, this policy
Confidential	Would cause harm if disclosed	Contracts, financials, unreleased plans, source code
Restricted	Personal or client data under legal obligation	Personnel records, client production data, payment data

When classification is unclear, treat the information as Confidential and ask the data owner. Do not default to a lower classification because it is more convenient.

Handling Restricted data

- Access only what a specific task requires. Curiosity is not a business need, and access logs are reviewed.

- Never copy Restricted data to personal devices, personal cloud storage, or personal email.
- Never use production personal data in a development, test, or demonstration environment. Request masked or synthetic data from the data owner instead.
- Report suspected exposure within **one hour** of discovery to Information Security. Delay in reporting is itself a policy violation, and an employee is never penalized for reporting an exposure they caused.

Approved AI tools

AI tools are approved per data class. Using a tool with a data class above its approval is a reportable security incident.

Tool category	Highest approved data class
TechLance enterprise AI assistant (SSO, no training on inputs)	Confidential
Approved vendor AI features inside contracted platforms	Internal
Public consumer AI tools (free or personal accounts)	Public only

Restricted data must not be entered into any AI tool, including the enterprise assistant, without written approval from the data owner and Information Security.

Employees are responsible for verifying AI output before use. See the Code of Conduct.

Networks and devices

- Company VPN is required on any network that is not a TechLance office network or the employee's home network. Public Wi-Fi without VPN is prohibited.
- Home networks must use WPA2 or better with a unique password.
- Devices must run current supported operating system versions with automatic updates and disk encryption enabled.
- Do not disable endpoint security software. If it interferes with work, contact IT Support rather than working around it.
- Lock the screen when stepping away, including at home.

Acceptable use

Company systems are for business use. Incidental personal use is permitted where it does not interfere with work, consume significant resources, or violate this policy.

Prohibited: - Installing unapproved software on company devices. - Circumventing security controls, including VPN, filtering, and logging. - Using company systems to store or transmit unlawful material. - Connecting unapproved external storage to company devices.

Employees should have no expectation of privacy in company systems. TechLance monitors systems for security and compliance purposes as permitted by law.

Phishing and social engineering

Report suspicious messages using the report button in the mail client. Do not forward them.

Be especially cautious with any message that creates urgency, requests credentials, requests a payment change, or requests gift cards. **Any request to change bank or payment details must be verified by voice with a known contact using a previously known number**, never a number supplied in the message itself.

Offboarding

Access is revoked on the final day of employment. Equipment must be returned within 10 business days. Retaining company data after separation is a breach of this policy and of the employment agreement.

Reporting

Security concerns go to Information Security. Incidents involving personal data are also reported to Legal and Compliance, which determines any notification obligation. That determination is not made by the reporting employee or their manager.